R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · WORKING WITH DATA · LESSON 1

01 The pipe and select(): build a smaller table

Use the pipe %>% and select() to keep only the columns you need.

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Type the pipe with Control, Shift and M
- Select columns into a new data frame
- Split long code over several lines

The R code in this lesson

```
library(dplyr)

# Pipe shortcut: Ctrl + Shift + M  (Mac: Cmd + Shift + M)
demographic <- Dataset %>% select('0.1 Province Name', '0.2 District Name',
                                  '0.11 Sex of household head',
                                  '0.12 Marital Status of household head',
                                  'HH Size')
View(demographic)
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro Big datasets can feel overwhelming. The trick is to keep only what you need. In this lesson, you will meet the pipe, one of the most loved tools in R, and use select to build a smaller, focused table. Let's make our data friendlier.

0:00 Here are two helpful shortcuts, written as notes. The pipe operator, percent, greater than, percent, has a shortcut: Control, Shift and M. And Shift and Enter helps when a command is long.

0:20 The pipe means: take this, and then do that. So Dataset, pipe, select, means: take the Dataset, and then select some columns.

0:40 Inside select, I list the columns I want, each in quotes: province name, district name, sex of household head, marital status, and household size.

1:02 Long lines are hard to read. So I press Enter after each comma, and RStudio keeps the code neatly lined up. R still reads it as one command.

1:25 At the front, I write: demographic, arrow. So the result is saved as a new data frame, called demographic.

1:45 Run it. In the Environment, demographic appears, with one hundred thirty five rows, and five columns. Same people, fewer columns.

1:52 Click on it, or use View, to open it like a spreadsheet. Here are our five columns: province, district, sex, marital status, and household size.

2:10 Look how much easier this is to read than the full dataset. Below in the script, I have also prepared the next steps: removing columns, and removing rows.

2:40 Take, and then do. That is the pipe. Once you get used to it, you will use it every day. Well done!